

FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST

ANSWERS

1. Do the Rules apply to the Sea Plane? (R.3) (1)

Yes, when manoeuvring on the water.(1)

2. If so, how should the Sea Plane operate, once it has landed? (R.18e) (2)

A seaplane on the water shall, in general, keep well clear of all vessels and avoid impeding their navigation.(1) In circumstance, however, where Risk of collision exist, she shall comply with the rules of this part.(1)

3. As you assess there is a risk of collision, does this change any obligations between you and the Sea Plane? (R.8fiii)(2)

No.(1) A vessel required not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel is not relieved of this obligation if approaching another vessel so as to involve risk of collision and shall, when taking action, have full regard to the action which may be required by the rules of this part. (1)

The Sea Plane passes at a safe distance, and you continue on passage towards Toulon, to meet with the rest of the exercise group. Your Nav Plan has you using a Traffic Separation Scheme, but utilising the Inshore Traffic zone, even though you are through traffic.

4. Are you correct to use the ITZ? Justify your answer. (R.10di)(2)

No.(1) A vessel shall not use an inshore traffic zone when she can safely use the appropriate traffic lane within the adjacent traffic separation scheme.(1)

5. When can you use the ITZ in accordance with the Rules? (R.10dii)(2)

A vessel may use an inshore traffic zone when *enroute* to or from a port, offshore installation or structure, pilot station or any other place situated within the Inshore Traffic Zone, or to avoid immediate danger.(2)

6. What do the IRPCS say about crossing traffic lanes within a TSS?(R.10c)(2)

A vessel shall, so far as practicable, avoid crossing traffic lanes but if obliged to do so shall cross on a heading as practicable at right angles to the general direction of traffic flow.(2)

7. How would you know if the TSS had been adopted by the IMO? Would it make any difference to your answer above? (R.10a)(2)

The list of adopted TSS is laid down in ASNTM, notice 17.(1) It would be considered the ordinary practice of seamen to follow a scheme adopted by a local authority.(1)

As you transit down the scheme, your look out notices a vessel not complying with the rules and not following the traffic lane.

8. What vessels are exempt from complying with the rules regarding TSS's and to what extent? (R.10k/l)(4)

A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre when engaged in an operation for the maintenance of the safety of navigation.(1) A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre when engaged in an operation for htelaying, servicing or picking up of a submarine cable (1). Both to the extent necessary to carry out the operation.(2)

As you round the headland, you notice a replenishment Group and a unit conducting flying ops all heading for the rendezvous.

9. Who has priority between the RAS group and the unit launching her helo? (ATP 1E) (2)

**Helo in the Dip,
Vessel engaged in Mineclearance Ops,
Replenishment Group,
Launching/recovering LCVPs,
Vessel engaged in launching/recovering aircraft
Vessel engaged in launching/recovering a towed array.**

Therefore the RAS group have priority. (2)

10. What do the rules state about keeping a good lookout?(R.5)(1)

Every vessel shall at all times maintain a proper and effective look-out by sight and hearing as well as by all available means appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and of the risk of collision.(1)

As predicted the weather begins to close in, and you assess that visibility is approximately 1 – 1.5nm. You are currently proceeding at 25 kts.

11. Do you consider this to be a safe speed? Justify your answer (R.6)(1)

In accordance with Rule 6, every vessel shall at all times proceeded at a safe speed so that she can take proper and effective action to avoid collision and be stopped within a distance appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions.

Yes, as a T23 can be stopped within approx 500yds. Traffic density also is among the factors to be considered.

12. How should radar be used to assist you in determining if RoC exists? (R.7b)(2)

Proper and effective use shall be made of radar equipment of fitted nad operational, including long range scanning to obtain early warning of risk of collision and radar plotting or equivalent systematic observation of detected objects.(2)

13. What factors shall be among those taken into account, assuming your radar is operational?(R.6b)(3)

The characteristics, efficiency and limitations of the radar equipment;(1/2)
 Any constraints imposed by the radar range scale in use; (1/2)
 The effect on radar detection of the sea state, weather and other sources of interference; (1/2)
 The possibility that small vessels, ice and other floating objects may not be detected by radar at an adequate range; (1/2)
 The number, location and movement of vessels detected by radar; (1/2)
 The more exact assessment of the visibility that may be possible when radar is used to determine the range of vessels or other objects within the vicinity. (1/2)

The weather continues to close, and visibility is now down to 5c. You begin your restricted visibility checkoffs.

14. How do the rules define restricted visibility? (R.3I)(1)

The term *restricted visibility* means any condition in which visibility is restricted by fog, mist, falling snow, heavy rainstorms, sandstorms or other similar causes.(1)

Having turned on your Navigation Lights, you decided to quiz the SFT YO on the range that your lights should be visible.

15. What are you expecting him to reply with?(R.22a)(2)

In a vessel of 50m or more in length;

- A masthead light, 6nm;
- A sidelight, 3nm;
- A sternlight, 3nm;
- A towing light, 3nm;
- A white, red, green or yellow all round light; 3nm.(2)

16. Your lookout reports hearing a sound signal apparently forward of the beam, but you have nothing on your radar. What do the rules state you should do? (R.19e)(2)

Except where it has been determined that a risk of collision does not exist, every vessel which hears apparently forward of her beam the fog signal of another vessel, or which cannot avoid a close quarters situation with another vessel forward of her beam, shall reduce her speed to the minimum she can be kept on course. She shall if necessary take all her way off and in any event navigate with extreme caution until danger of collision is over.(2)

You take the correct actions, and coming through the gloom, you spot the outline of a French warship. Your QM remarks that although clearly the French warship is of a similar size to you, she only has been designed to carry one mast head light.

17. How is this allowed in accordance with the IRPCS? (R.1e)(2)

Whenever the Government concerned shall have determined that a vessel of special construction or purpose cannot comply fully provisions of any of these rules with respect to the number, position, range of arc of visibility of lights or shapes, as well as to the disposition and characteristics of sound signalling appliances, such vessel shall comply with other such provisions in regard to

the number, position, range of arc of visibility of lights or shapes, as well as to the disposition and characteristics of sound signalling appliances, as her Government shall have determined to be the closest possible compliance with these rules in respect of that vessel.(2)

The weather improves (visibility approx 5nm) and you now form up with the rest of the NATO exercise group. As you transit towards the RV, you notice a large square rigged sailing vessel, proceeding under sail.

18. How do the Rules describe the windward side of a sailing vessel? (R.12b)(1)

The windward side shall be deemed to be the side opposite to that on which the mainsail is carried, or, in the case of a square rigged vessel, the side opposite to that on which the largest fore-and-aft sail is carried.(1)

19. As the situation with the sailing vessel is being resolved, the SCC request an "Emergency Stop" on both shafts. What condition can you now claim?(R.3)(1)

This is an exceptional circumstance therefore you are not under command (1)

20. What shapes, if any, will you now show? (R.27)(1)

Two black balls in a vertical line (1)

21. If a Risk of collision existed between you and the sailing vessel, would this change the situation (R.18b) (1)

Yes, the sailing vessel shall keep out of the way of a vessel Not Under Command. (1)

22. If this defect had occurred whilst you were in reduced visibility, what sound signal (if any) should you be making? (R.35) (1)

A vessel Not Under Command shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes (1/2) three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged blast followed by two short blasts.(1/2)

The SCC repairs the defect, and you start making ground to catch up with the rest of the force, and hand over to your relief.

You return to the Bridge for the Middle. The first hour proceeds without incident. The port lookout reports the following lights at R10:

		R		
		W		
		R		
		W		
	G		R	
R				G
R				G

23. What type of vessel is this? (R.27d)(3)

A PDV, (1/2)over 50m in length, (1/2) Restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, (1/2) underway, seen from ahead(1/2), obstruction exists on her STBD side, (1/2) safe to pass on her PORT side. (1/2)

24. What sound signal would this vessel make in restricted visibility? (R.35) (1)

A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes (1/2) three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged blast followed by two short blasts.(1/2)

25. If you needed more time to ascertain the exact developing situation, what would you do? (R.8e) (1)

If necessary to avoid collision, or to avoid more time to assess the situation, a vessel shall slacken her speed or take all way off by stopping or reversing her means of propulsion.(1)

26. When determining whether or not a risk of collision exists what should you take into consideration and what should avoid when making assumptions? (R.7d) (3)

In determining if risk of collision exists the following considerations shall be among those taken into account:

i Such risk shall be deemed to exist if the compass bearing of an approaching vessel does not appreciably change;(1)

ii Such risk may sometimes exist even when an appreciable bearing change is evident, particularly when approaching a very large vessel or tow or when approaching a vessel at close range. (2)

27. If there is sufficient sea room, what may be the most effective action to avoid a close quarters situation?(R.8c)(1)

If there is sufficient sea room, alteration of course alone may be the most effective action to avoid a close quarters situation provided that it is made in good time, is substantial and does not result in another close quarters situation.(1)

28. What vessels shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a Narrow Channel or Fairway?(R.9)(2)

A vessel of less than 20m in length or a sailing vessel shall not impeded the passage of another vessel which can safely navigate within a narrow channel or fairway.(1)

A vessel engaged in fishing shall not impede the passage of any other vessel navigating within a narrow channel or fairway.(1/2)

A vessel shall not cross a narrow channel or fairway if such crossing impedes the passage of a vessel which can only navigate within such channel or fairway.(1/2)

Total _____ / 50